

COLORADO RARE BIRD REPORT

PRAIRIE WARBLER
Dendroica discolor

7-0 (A)
Recd 2/2/01 wpl

Location: "Wood Thrush Grove" about 1 mile north of Ft. Lyon Wildlife Easement (intersection Rds 16 and JJ); Bent County; near Las Animas, Colorado

Date: May 14, 2000

I was birding with Brandon Percival. We found the bird at 7:45 a.m. and we observed it for ten minutes. We were first drawn to it by the song which it delivered from the tall cottonwoods -- which we both recognized as belonging to this species right away. The song consisted of a series of high buzzing, zippy notes, rising in pitch: "zoo zoo zoo zii zii zeeEEETTT!". Brandon found the bird quite easily and we observed it for a few minutes with our binoculars.

Description:

The bird was an adult male in breeding plumage. It was small, slim, longish-tailed, about 5" long with a small, pointed dark bill. Eye, legs and feet were dark. The bird was uniform pale greenish gray above with rufous streaks on the back. The wings were this same color without noticeable wingbars. The face was grayish with a wide, yellow eye crescent below the eye and a yellow superciliary. The yellow eye crescent was framed by a darker, nearly black facial mark. This was a tipped-over "D"-shaped face pattern. The bird was yellow underneath, with a white undertail. It had distinct, sharp black streaking along the yellow flanks.

Similar Species:

Kinglets and vireos lack the distinct flank streaking. The bright yellow underparts rule out many other warblers. Orange-crowned has yellow undertail coverts, lacks the distinct flank streaks and does not wag the tail. Blackburnian has strong wingbars, a distinctive face pattern and a diagnostic yellow streak across the back that this bird lacked. Magnolia has a yellow rump, lacks this face pattern and has distinct wingbars. Yellow-rumped has a yellow rump, is never bright yellow below in this plumage and lacks the face pattern. Pine never has this distinct streaks below, has whitish wingbars. Canada has a spectacled face, slate gray back, pink legs.

Experience with Species:

I have seen many Prairie Warblers -- several times before in Colorado.

This report is prepared from notes made after observation and from memory.

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